

# Keep the premise. Rebuild the rules.

A distinctive road-trip satire with substantial implementation and asset mistakes.

The app is reachable and has a real playable scaffold. Its strongest idea is a contemporary Oregon Trail parody: five travelers, a scruffy van, resources, roadside setbacks and Portland as an increasingly absurd promised land. The green terminal and illustrated-van identity already communicate that premise.



## What to preserve

Loaded van, Pacific Northwest atmosphere, eccentric travelers, dry resource jokes, green illustrations and monospaced menus.

## What needs rebuilding

Event resolution, New Game, saves, death/resource rules, phone layout and the relationship between each illustration and its content.

## What the handoff contains

18 documented findings; 14 settled screenshots; all published images; the supplied 39-file export and byte comparison; a proposed asset brief and Codex rebuild prompt.

**The clearest asset failure:** the victory screen and one roadside landmark display source-file browser screenshots. A routine rest stop displays virus game-over art. These are incorrect assignments, not a problem with the premise.

**Evidence limits.** UI clicks were combined with deterministic event/resource setup in a separate browser session. The supplied export was compared byte for byte with deployed files. No repository history or GenSpark editor was inspected. Phone checks used Chromium viewports, not physical-device Safari. No representative win-rate simulation was performed.

Source: <https://heuxnwuv.gensparkspace.com/>

# What is actually present

Seven screen states, a modal, a HUD, and a small client-side game engine.

| System            | Present behavior / content                                                                                             |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Start and setup   | New Game, Load Game, alert-based credits; four selectable backgrounds; five companion names and random-name buttons.   |
| Supplies          | Six product types, quantities, price total and affordability disabling. Initial supplies depend on profession.         |
| Travel            | Three paces, three ration settings, weather, route progress, journal, Rest and Forage.                                 |
| Locations         | Seven configured milestones and five displayed actions; declared activity permissions are currently ignored.           |
| Encounters        | Nine definitions: six automatic, two choices and one critical. Choice resolution works in the tested repair encounter. |
| Endings and saves | Win/loss screens and localStorage save/load exist; several transition and restoration defects are documented.          |

**Ordinary flow verified:** New Game - select background - name companions - enter shop - change quantity - purchase - travel. A van-breakdown choice applied its stated one-day delay. A turn from 180 to 200 miles reached the first stop. A near-end test state rendered victory at 1000 miles.

| Background | Cash    | Food | Fuel |
|------------|---------|------|------|
| Influencer | \$2,000 | 20   | 15   |
| Developer  | \$1,200 | 30   | 20   |
| Prepper    | \$800   | 100  | 25   |
| Barista    | \$1,000 | 50   | 20   |

**Route:** guest-room/co-op departure (0), rest stop (200), motel (350), viral landmark (470), DeFi backroom (670), food-cart pod (750), Portland (1000 miles).

**Architecture confirmed by the export:** one HTML file, one stylesheet, two JavaScript files and JPEG scenes. The deployed code matches the supplied export byte for byte. No live LLM calls, server API, sprite animation or audio were found. Several README claims are inaccurate; see page 9.

# The mechanics fail in specific ways

Runtime probes reproduce these failures; proposed outcomes are in findings.json.

| Priority / ids | Observed failure                                                                                                            | Root cause                                                                      |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P0 / F01       | Critical pandemic encounter closes; five health values stay at 100 and the run continues.                                   | closeEvent executes only auto outcomes.                                         |
| P0 / F02       | New Game retains 400 miles and day 21 from a saved run.                                                                     | Constructor initialization merges the old save.                                 |
| P1 / F03-04    | Auto weather bonus changes state to 15 miles, while UI/save stay at 0. Pending event loses its functions and modal on load. | No full commit after auto events; JSON strips functions; no modal restoration.  |
| P1 / F05-06    | Rest with zero food revives a Deceased companion to 15 health. One fuel at fast pace becomes -2 after 30 miles.             | Rest heals all members; resource checks do not match selected action cost.      |
| P1 / F07-08    | Loss recreates its save. Leaving a location shop jumps to travel. All activities appear at every stop.                      | Processing continues after loss; shop return is hard-coded; permissions unused. |

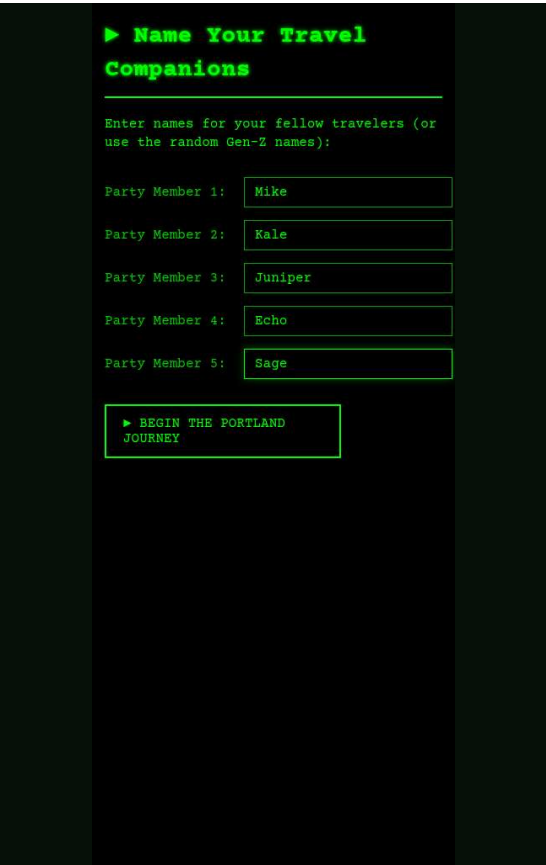
**Feature gaps from source review.** The developer gets one starting NFT, but the other advertised profession powers and repair discounts are not wired into actions. Seed bombs and kombucha have no usable consumer. Foraging adds food without a resource or health cost. Locals write a response to the hidden travel log.

**Balance needs an explicit pass.** All baseline paces use one canister per ten miles: 100 canisters for the route, before bonuses. At \$60 each, no profession can cover that fuel from initial cash and fuel alone, even before food purchases. Events and NFT sales can alter the result; this is a budget check, not a measured claim that winning is impossible.

**Recommended rule model:** one action transition resolves effects, resource costs, journal updates, arrival/ending checks, screen state and save together. Store stable event ids and pending choices. Keep death terminal. Test the broken cases directly before tuning presentation.

# Style and phone usability

The retro identity works. The layout needs a compact play composition.



430 px  
Random buttons lie at x=442..516, outside the viewport.

390 px  
Square art, an oversized route heading and the fixed HUD dominate the first view. Continue is further down.

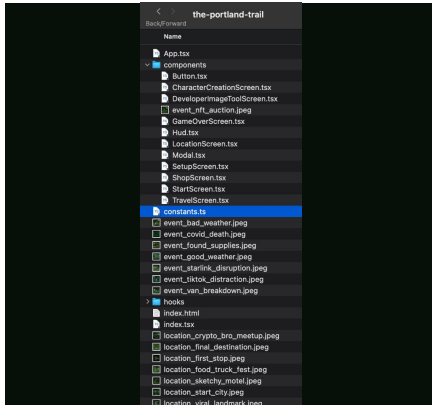
**Present style:** Courier Prime/Courier, black canvas, luminous green borders, glow on headings, cyan metadata, colored health/warning text and green illustrated posters. The art is pixel-like rather than a verified fixed-grid sprite system. The route marker is a colored car emoji; there are no consistent inventory icons or background portraits.

| Role                  | Observed CSS color |
|-----------------------|--------------------|
| Canvas / main action  | #000000 / #00FF00  |
| Secondary / body text | #00AA00 / #00CC00  |
| Information / warning | #00DDDD / #FFAA00  |
| Danger / success      | #FF6666 / #00FF66  |

**Proposed improvements:** shorten visible place labels; keep art, resources and the next action together; replace 50vh bottom-padding with deliberate spacing; make shop +/- controls easier to tap; provide keyboard-operable background choices and modal focus handling. Preserve the game character while making status and choices legible.

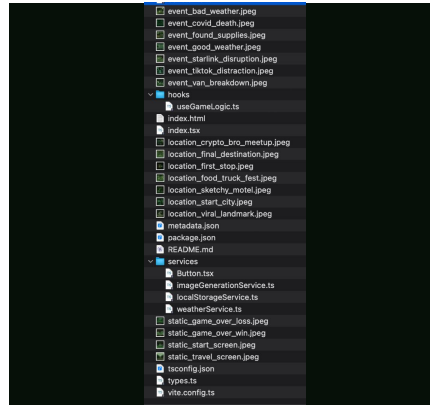
# Artwork is frequently assigned incorrectly

All referenced files load, but HTTP success does not establish semantic correctness.



## VICTORY

Source-file browser screenshot.



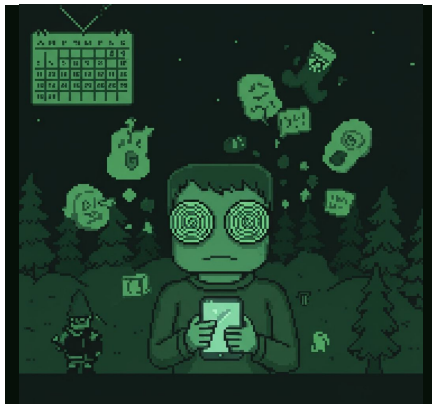
## VIRAL LANDMARK

Source-file browser screenshot.



## FIRST REST STOP

Says GAME OVER - THE VIRUS WINS.



## VAN BREAKDOWN

Phone spiral / doomsrolling scene.



## HEATWAVE

Wi-Fi-outage cafe scene.



## PANDEMIC

Rainy driving / upbeat van scene.

**18 filenames, 16 unique images.** The start-city scene is exactly the title image. The motel image is exactly the ISP-outage image. Most illustrations are 1024 x 1024 JPEGs; the two file-browser images are 409 x 1024. Several scenes also include garbled lettering or an inappropriate baked-in title/ending.

**Additional mismatches:** the crypto backroom shows food carts; the food-cart pod shows a forest van; the destination shows a smoking van in a forest. Food poisoning shares the Free Box illustration. The NFT and doomsrolling pictures provide weak cues for their events. See `asset_inventory.json` for every slot and the full-resolution contact sheet for all files.

**Asset priority:** correct the image-to-content mapping, replace screenshots and terminal art in routine scenes, then unify the van, characters, palette and scene crops. Filenames alone are not a visual quality check.

# A useful asset production sequence

Recommendations for new graphics; none of these new assets is claimed complete.

| Batch                   | Deliverable                                                                                | Proposed format                                                                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Wrong / ending art   | Victory, distinct loss, viral attraction; then correct rest-stop and encounter mismatches. | 640 x 360 scenes; important content safe for a central 4:3 crop.                 |
| 2. Resource symbols     | Money, kale chips, fuel, seed bombs, repair kit, kombucha, NFT.                            | 7 individual transparent 32 x 32 PNGs; optional 64 px masters.                   |
| 3. Background portraits | Influencer, developer, prepper, barista.                                                   | 4 coherent 64 x 64 bust portraits with alpha.                                    |
| 4. Van states           | Parked, rolling A/B, hood-open breakdown, arrival.                                         | 5 fixed 128 x 64 cells; 640 x 64 sheet plus individual files and frame manifest. |
| 5. Party status         | Healthy, sick, injured, deceased, selected.                                                | 24 or 32 px symbols paired with live status text.                                |
| 6. Travel environment   | One reusable damp forest-road scene; van separated if animated.                            | 640 x 360 master; optional layers only when needed.                              |
| Next pass               | 7 route establishing scenes and 9 event vignettes matching the actual ids.                 | Reuse approved subjects and scenery; start with incorrect slots.                 |

**Proposed art palette:** near-black #07110A, dark #18331B, middle #426E35, highlight #A4C96A. This is a production proposal, not an exact palette extracted from the current JPEGs. Keep brighter phosphor accents in the interface and readable softer text.

**Production contract:** live UI supplies words, quantities and titles. Cutouts have true alpha; scenes are opaque. Fixed-grid sprites need matching cell dimensions, van scale, baseline, gutters and a JSON frame map. Review concept sheets before exporting individual assets. Clean generated pixel-like art before calling it a production sprite sheet.

# Prompts that preserve the character

ASSET\_BRIEF.txt contains the full production brief and scene-specific inserts.

Use the current title van as a visual reference. The prompts below describe concepts; exact export geometry and frame layout are separate production checks.

## SCENE MASTER

Original satirical road-trip game illustration for The Portland Trail. Battered eco-van with mismatched luggage, earnest eccentric travelers, Pacific Northwest conifers and damp roadside atmosphere. Early handheld-computer pixel-art aesthetic, controlled green palette on near-black, crisp silhouettes, consistent heavy outlines and restrained dithering. [SCENE]. Keep the approved van and traveler proportions. No titles, captions, UI, menus, borders, file trees or generated lettering. Compose for 16:9 with a safe central 4:3 crop.

## RESOURCE ICON CONCEPTS

Seven separated inventory concepts: crumpled money, kale-chip bag, bio-diesel canister, seed-ball cluster, washi tape with screwdriver, kombucha bottle, framed pixel collectible with USB. Uniform handheld-game style, four green shades, strong silhouettes, consistent top-left light and outline. Centered objects, generous spacing, no labels or numbers, true transparent background. Review the concepts; export seven individual fixed-cell PNGs.

## BACKGROUND PORTRAITS

Four original bust portraits: earnest influencer, sleep-deprived freelance developer, Portland doomsday prepper and artisanal barista. Same head size, crop, eye line, pixel grid and green palette. One or two legible profession props each. No words, logos or card frames. Transparent background. Final portraits exported individually at 64 x 64.

## VAN DESIGN

One battered compact eco-van, perfect side view facing right. Four-green palette, strong outline, recognizable roof-load arrangement, readable wheels and windows. No text or logos. True transparency. Approve one silhouette first, then derive parked, two rolling frames, hood-open and arrival states. All final frames share the same 128 x 64 cell and ground baseline.

**Generation order:** approve one style/van reference, then resource and portrait concepts, then a small set of corrected scenes. Keep the first batch small enough to revise before making every event image.

# The Codex rebuild handoff

Preserve a small game. Make one complete route work before expanding it.

**Recommended starting point:** use the supplied export and the byte comparison with the live app. Salvage its four additional useful illustrations before generating replacements. Use the Sites workflow available in the rebuild session. A static browser frontend and versioned local saves fit the current mechanics. Separate deterministic rules from rendering; use serializable ids for event state.

| Acceptance area       | Concrete checks                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| State and events      | New Game resets all state. Auto/choice/critical effects apply once. Pending encounters survive reload. HUD, scene, journal and save agree.               |
| Resources and party   | Actions cannot overspend or create negative fuel. Death stays terminal. Rest/forage follow deliberate costs. Advertised profession powers actually work. |
| Route and shops       | Arrival and event bonuses trigger appropriate transitions. Location activities follow data. Leaving a shop returns to the correct location.              |
| Endings and replay    | Distinct correct victory/loss art. Terminal turns stop. Replay starts clean; save policy is consistent.                                                  |
| Usability and balance | Controls fit 390, 414, 430, 768 and 1440 px. Keyboard choices and modal focus work. Verify a few seeded full routes, including a win and a loss.         |

**Files to give Codex:** HANDOFF\_TO\_CODEX.txt, ASSET\_BRIEF.txt, both asset inventories, findings.json, screenshots, and the provided export / published snapshot. The text handoff contains the proposed implementation scope and a twelve-item acceptance checklist.

**Suggested order:** rule and save fixes; one complete playable route; corrected high-priority artwork; compact phone UI; coherent icons/portraits/van frames; targeted visual and route checks; Sites preview and deployment when the rebuild is requested.

**Unresolved decisions for that session:** how far to refresh the NFT/pandemic humor; the final fuel/resupply economy; exact profession powers; and whether the van remains static or gets the small two-frame drive animation. This evaluation does not silently settle those product choices.

The supplied export and verified live behavior give the rebuild a concrete starting point. The asset brief identifies what can be reused and what the next graphics batch should supply.

# What the supplied export adds

39 files; deployed code matches exactly; four unused illustrations can be salvaged.

The archive code\_sandbox\_light\_db8de4e3\_1790840601.zip contains the exact deployed HTML, CSS, both JavaScript files and all 18 referenced images. It adds a README, 15 numbered original JPEGs and an unreferenced loss JPEG. Its 34 image files contain 20 unique pictures: four more than the live app uses.



Crypto / DeFi room  
00010.jpg



Roadside rest / vending stop  
00003.jpg



Departure bedroom / co-op  
00018.jpg



Actual Portland victory  
00016.jpg

| README claim                          | Verified implementation                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10 random events                      | 9: six auto, two choice, one critical.                                                                                  |
| 10% encounter chance                  | 30% on each travelDay invocation.                                                                                       |
| Dynamic shop prices                   | Fixed ITEMS.basePrice; no location pricing.                                                                             |
| Pace changes event frequency          | Pace changes miles and fuel, not event probability.                                                                     |
| All powers / unique special-item uses | Most profession powers are descriptive only; seed bombs and kombucha have no consumer.                                  |
| Different win/loss illustrations      | Win uses a file-browser screenshot. Loss method renders no image; unused loss JPEG duplicates the heatwave/Wi-Fi scene. |

**Practical consequence:** retain the export as source evidence, not as a verified feature specification. Start the art repair with its unused victory, room and rest-stop pictures, then remap existing phone/repair/food-cart scenes where they fit. Update the README to describe the implementation that actually ships.